

— FREE DIY GUIDE



46 Ways Your Business Is *Leaking Time.*

A plain-English audit of your website, follow-up, CRM, content, and back office — what to look for, why it costs you, and what to do about it. No jargon, no upsell required.

Second Set

A second set of hands for your business · hello@secondsethq.com

You're not disorganized. You're *outnumbered*.

Every small business owner we meet says a version of the same thing: *I know there's stuff I should be doing, I just don't know what's actually costing me money.*

That's the problem this guide solves. It isn't a list of best practices you'll never get to — it's a diagnostic. Forty-six specific places where small businesses quietly lose hours and leads, grouped by the part of the business they live in. Tick the ones that describe you. The pattern that emerges tells you where to start.

A FEW GROUND RULES BEFORE YOU DIVE IN

- **Nobody scores well.** If you tick fifteen boxes, you're normal. Ten is good. Under five and you probably don't need us.
- **Fix in order of bleeding.** A broken follow-up costs more than an out-of-date logo. Start where money is actively walking out.
- **Most fixes are one-time.** The reason these leaks persist isn't difficulty — it's that nobody has an afternoon free to close them.
- **You can do all of this yourself.** That's the point of the guide. Hire it out only if the afternoon never comes.

HOW TO READ YOUR RESULTS

0–5

You're in good shape. Pick off the stragglers and get back to work.

6–14

Typical for a growing business. There's real time to reclaim — usually concentrated in one or two sections.

15–25

You're carrying more than one person should. Fix follow-up and back office first; they compound fastest.

26+

Nothing's wrong with you — the systems were never built. Start from scratch on one section at a time.

Your website & *getting found*

YOUR WEBSITE

- ☐ A visitor can't tell what you sell within five seconds of landing on your homepage.
- ☐ There's no obvious next step on the page — nothing to click, book, or download.
- ☐ Something on the site is out of date: old pricing, a former team member, last year's hours.
- ☐ You've never opened your own site on a phone and scrolled the whole thing.
- ☐ Your contact form goes somewhere you don't check daily — or you've never tested that it works.
- ☐ There's nothing on the site a visitor can get for free without talking to you.
- ☐ You don't know when your domain renews, or whose card it's on.

BEING FOUND

- ☐ Your Google Business Profile is unclaimed, or hasn't been touched in a year.
- ☐ Your hours, address, or phone number differ between Google, your site, and social.
- ☐ You have no process for asking happy customers to leave a review.
- ☐ You don't know which search terms bring people to you — or whether any do.
- ☐ You've never written anything on your site that answers a question customers actually ask.

WHERE THE MONEY IS

The five-second test is the highest-leverage item on this page. Ask three people outside your industry to look at your homepage and tell you what you do. If they hesitate, it isn't a design problem — it's a sentence problem, and it's costing you every visitor.

Follow-up & your *customer data*

FOLLOW-UP & FUNNELS

- ☐ A new enquiry can sit more than 24 hours before anyone replies.
- ☐ Nobody gets an automatic acknowledgment when they fill in your form.
- ☐ People who enquire and don't buy are never contacted again.
- ☐ You have no email list — or one you haven't mailed in over three months.
- ☐ Booking a call with you requires back-and-forth to find a time.
- ☐ You couldn't say how many leads you got last month without guessing.
- ☐ Your quotes go out and you rely on memory to chase them.

CRM & CUSTOMER DATA

- ☐ Customer details live in more than one place — phone, inbox, a spreadsheet, someone's head.
- ☐ You have a CRM but stopped trusting the data in it.
- ☐ Nobody can tell at a glance which stage a deal is at.
- ☐ Your website form doesn't feed your CRM — someone retypes it.
- ☐ If a team member left tomorrow, their client relationships would leave with them.
- ☐ You've never segmented your list, so everyone gets the same message.

WHERE THE MONEY IS

Speed beats polish. Businesses that reply within an hour convert dramatically better than those that reply the next day — and an automatic acknowledgment buys you that hour honestly. It's usually a 20-minute setup, and it's the single cheapest fix in this guide.

How you look & *what you say*

BRAND & FIRST IMPRESSIONS

- ☐ Your logo appears in different versions or colors depending on where you look.
- ☐ You don't have your fonts, colors, and logo files saved in one place you can send someone.
- ☐ Your headshot is more than three years old — or you don't have one.
- ☐ Your social profiles, website, and printed material don't look like the same company.
- ☐ You're still using something you'd be embarrassed to hand a big client.

CONTENT & WORDS

- ☐ Your website copy describes what you do, not what the customer gets.
- ☐ You post to social when you remember, not to a plan.
- ☐ You write every email from scratch, including the ones you send constantly.
- ☐ There's a page or post you've been meaning to write for over three months.
- ☐ You have no testimonials collected in writing — only nice things people said out loud.

WHERE THE MONEY IS

Templates beat willpower. Five saved email templates — enquiry reply, quote follow-up, onboarding, invoice chase, review request — remove more weekly friction than any app you could install. Write them once on a quiet afternoon.

The back office & *your own time*

BOOKS, INVOICING & ADMIN

- ☐ Your bookkeeping is more than a month behind.
- ☐ You couldn't say today what you're owed and by whom.
- ☐ Invoices go out manually, whenever you get to it.
- ☐ Nobody chases overdue invoices on a schedule.
- ☐ Receipts live in a shoebox, an inbox, or a glovebox.
- ☐ Clients can't pay you online in one click.
- ☐ You're paying for software you no longer use — or aren't sure.

PROJECTS, VENDORS & YOU

- ☐ Your to-do list lives in your head, a notes app, and three sticky notes.
- ☐ Nothing is written down for tasks you do the same way every time.
- ☐ Passwords get shared over text, or everyone uses the same one.
- ☐ You're the only person who can do at least three things in the business.

WHERE THE MONEY IS

Unpaid invoices are the most expensive item in this guide, because the work is already done. A scheduled chase at 7, 14, and 30 days — automated, unemotional, sent whether you're in the mood or not — typically recovers more in a month than any marketing you could run.

Pick three. *Not thirty.*

Go back through your ticks and circle the three that made you wince hardest. Those are your next three jobs — not the whole list. Businesses that try to fix everything at once fix nothing; businesses that close three leaks a quarter are unrecognizable in a year.

If you'd rather hand the list to someone else, that's exactly what we do — we're Second Set, a second set of hands for the work you can't get to.

Denessa Appleton

MARKETING, BRAND & DESIGN

12+ years building brands, websites, funnels, and campaigns — for names like Emirates Airlines and Mercedes-Benz, and for small businesses that just needed to look as good as they are.

Brittany Hadfield

OPERATIONS, SYSTEMS & CRM

18 years running operations beside C-level executives in hospitality and property development. Certified in HubSpot and Ontraport, and the person who builds the structure underneath.

Want the three *fixed* for you?

Book a free 30-minute call. Bring your ticked list — we'll tell you honestly which ones matter, what they'd take, and which you should just do yourself. No pitch, no pressure, no obligation.

BOOK A FREE CALL → HELLO@SECONDSETHQ.COM